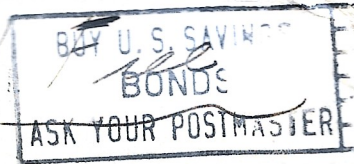


Pvt. Q.T. Hoffstetter Jr.
Flight 8 Section I
Inf. Det. A.A.F. T.T.C.
Washington D.
St. Louis Mo.



Miss Martha Darrough
(Miss Florence Nightingale)
Lutheran Hospital School of Nursing
St. Louis (18) Mo

July 17, 1943
My Dearest Martha:

I would like to open my letter with a joke. The old jokes are the best. Like the one about the man who, about to be hanged, was asked if he had anything to say and his answer was: yes, sir, I want to say this is going to be a lesson to me."

If you do not like the opening tell me, please take it easy.

I am sitting writing this letter. I do not know why ^{because} ~~because~~ the other boys have gone to a big parade. And if there is anything I like is a parade with a band. But I feel a lot better when I write to you. Boy, I should do not know why, because before I got in the army I never wrote a letter in my life. But I real enjoy getting one from you (letters I mean). Do you know I get more letters from you than any body in S.T. Paris.

Well teni for any joke if you can stand it. On record through you better sit down. "The tale of the traveler in the Blue Ridge mountains who saw an old man sitting at a cabin door and asked: "Have you lived here all your life?" To which the old gent answered patiently: "not yet." Bay is that corn!! I better stop telling you them.

Now to get to that great letter. You know that it was the first letter I got old week and the second one from you. Maybe we can get our private mail service or pony express. You know, well of course you would not untill I told you, that I read you letter about 4 times before I did any thing. Well at least you can say that you ~~has~~ do some thing for the war. You keep a soldier happy (me).

So you went swimming Friday. Well how did you like it? I was going swimming too but

we had to shoot on the firing range. Please do not ask me how I did that is a military secret!

I hope I can get a date but its look it will be after you come back from your vacation. I tried to call you once but you were not in. That is a long vacation from 20th to the 9th say you would not like to trade place for that time. Does Pearl get that long too?

When you get this letter do not answer it until you get home. I know how it is when you are trying to go home. I had the same trouble and I lived in St. Louis.

Do you mean to tell me that you would not like to have breakfast in bed. That is even better than the Capt he do not have his in bed. Tell me how much would you give to have your breakfast in bed for a week.

x

Which will happen when you are home. Try it once.

There was a break at this point for a coke + cake.

Now I better stop over with a joke (any way I think so).

A Jewish merchant was dying, and momma, his two daughters and three sons were at the bedside saying the Kaddish. Finally momma bent over her departing spouse and sobbed: "Can you hear, pappa? Well, are all here — all your daughters and sons and old momma, praying for you."

"Is Milton here?" whispered the dying man.

"Is Moe here?"

"Is Abe here?"

"yes, pappa."

"yes, Poppa."

"yes, Pappa."

With a scream of anguish pappa sat up in bed. "Then who in hell's looking after the store?"

Listen if you do not like these jokes

tell me and I will stop (maybe).

I do not have a story about my pitching on the fire. But I will cook me up, I hope. Maybe I could start writing story for the papers.

I am not good with baseball, football is my sport. That is one you can get you teeth into.

Say how about hearing sort of your story of your life. You did some thing when you were in high school. But the story will keep untill you get home. So write it then.

If you see any good pictures please tell me that is all I like for is shows.

I rose to work in one and on my night off I would go to a ———. I think you are right in the guess you made.

One
hole day → There is a interruption as you can see by the color of the ink. I am at home writing. It is Sunday and I went to two shows. I went to one at show at 1:00 P.M. Sunday. Some Sun.

I would like to close with a joke
 I hope this will not kill you.
 I will not.

While running to catch a
 bus, Loretta, a secretary at the
 Service center, slipped & fell. A
 man rushed past her, calling
 out, "I'll hold the bus for you.
 Get up quick."

I am home and I am looking for
 a picture. So I will send it to your
 home. and I will write the next letter
 to your house.

I will close now it is
 about time.

Your Pal (I hope)

"750p"